Protecting Yourself from Fraud and Scams

Financial fraud is common and constantly evolving. A few simple habits dramatically reduce your risk of losing money to criminals.

Phishing

Phishing is a scam where attackers impersonate a trusted organisation in emails, texts, or calls to trick you into revealing passwords or card details. Warning signs include urgent threats, requests for sensitive information, misspelled web addresses, and links that do not match your bank's real website. When in doubt, do not click; instead, type the bank's address yourself or call the number on the back of your card.

Two-factor authentication

Two-factor authentication (2FA) adds a second check beyond your password, such as a one-time code from an app or sent to your phone. Even if a criminal steals your password, they cannot log in without that second factor, so 2FA greatly reduces account takeover.

Strong, unique passwords

Reusing one password across many sites means a single breach can compromise all of them. Use a long, unique password for each financial account, and a reputable password manager to store them. This is one of the highest-impact security habits.

Card skimming

Card skimming uses hidden devices on ATMs or payment terminals to copy your card data. Cover the keypad when entering your PIN, check machines for loose or unusual attachments, and prefer contactless or chip transactions over magnetic-stripe swipes.

Identity theft

Identity theft happens when someone uses your personal information to open accounts or make purchases in your name. Protect documents, shred old statements, and monitor your credit report so you can detect and limit damage early.

Investment scams

Investment scams promise unusually high, guaranteed returns with little or no risk. Red flags include pressure to act fast, unlicensed sellers, and strategies that cannot be clearly explained. If an offer sounds too good to be true, it almost always is.